Audit Clinical Evidence

COVER LETTER | [ACE-ID]
[Date]
auditclinicalevidence.org
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[Recipient name], [Editor-in-Chief]
[Journal], [Publisher]
via [editor@example.org]
cc [Research Integrity Office], [integrity@example.org]

Audit report [ACE-ID] on an article published in [Journal]
[Authors (Year). Title. Journal, volume(issue), pages]
DOI [10.xxxx/xxxxx]

Dear [Recipient name],

Audit Clinical Evidence (ACE) is an independent initiative that publishes reproducible audits of clinical research. We write to make you aware of our audit of the article cited above. The report, [ACE-ID], is published on the ACE website and permanently archived with a DOI. A copy is enclosed.

Report [https://auditclinicalevidence.org/reports/ACE-ID/]
Archive https://doi.org/[10.5281/zenodo.xxxxxxx]

The audit finds serious errors in the article. [Two to four sentences giving the headline findings, in the order they appear in the report's abstract. State what the article reports, what the audit found, and what follows for the article's conclusions. No numbers that are not in the report.] In total, the report documents [N] errors or integrity concerns. Every number in the report is computed from the article's published values with code that accompanies the report, so each finding can be checked independently. On the basis of these findings, ACE recommends [retraction / a correction / an expression of concern]. The decision belongs to the journal.

We ask that the journal assess the report under its research integrity procedures and the COPE guidelines, and let us know the outcome. [ACE has not contacted the authors. / ACE wrote to the corresponding author on DATE and has received no reply. / The authors' response is published with the report.] We would welcome a response from the authors and will publish any response alongside the report, in full or quoted in part, as described in our correspondence policy at https://auditclinicalevidence.org/disclaimers.

ACE records its correspondence with journals on a public page, https://auditclinicalevidence.org/correspondence, which shows the date this letter was sent, the date of any reply, and the journal's decision. Addresses on that page are taken from public records. If this letter should go to a different office, we would be grateful for the correct address.

Sincerely,

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on behalf of Audit Clinical Evidence